

Program Guidance

Acies Global Virtual Labs

Program: Capstone Program - Acies Global Associate Training

Audience: Associate Trainee Teams (8 teams, one lab each)

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1. Program Context

1.1 What Acies Global Global is Building

Acies Global is building a suite of eight interactive Virtual Labs, collectively branded as the **Acies Agentic Bus** Virtual Labs. These are not slide decks or marketing videos. They are working, browser-based interactive demos that a VP-level business leader can sit in front of, explore, and walk away from with a clear understanding of:

- What the problem area looks like when it's working well (and when it isn't)
- How AI and analytics can improve decisions in that domain
- How Acies Global's agentic operating model — the **Acies Agentic Bus** — takes that further

These labs are a core GTM (Go-To-Market) asset. They are designed to open conversations with Senior Director / VP-level leaders.

1.2 Who Uses These Labs

The primary audience is **functional VPs and senior leaders** one or two levels below CXO — VP Supply Chain, VP Marketing, VP Operations, VP Finance Ops, VP Procurement, VP Logistics, VP Product, VP Customer Experience. The lab must feel immediately relevant to what they do every day.

Secondary users are **practitioners** — the planners, analysts, managers, and leads who report to those VPs. They need a different depth and emphasis in tooltips and guided tours.

1.3 The Acies Agentic Bus

Every lab is part of the **Acies Agentic Bus** brand. The Agentic Bus is Acies Global's framework for how AI-assisted decisions evolve into agentic, orchestrated operations over time. In the labs, the Agentic Bus appears as a **storytelling artifact** — a "How This Evolves" side panel that slides in from the right — not as the main UI. The main experience is always the interactive functional modules.

The consistent narrative across all labs:

Now (fragmented, reactive, manual) → AI-Assisted (smarter decisions, faster signals) → Acies Global Agentic Bus (orchestrated, agent-led workflows)

2. What You Are Being Asked to Do

Each trainee team is assigned **one lab**. You will:

1. **Understand** the problem area deeply — business context, users, workflows, pain points, data
2. **Design** the solution — what the interactive lab should show, how it is structured, how different roles experience it
3. **Build** the fully functional virtual lab in HTML/CSS/JS according to the common shell specification

Your work is evaluated in three stages:

Stage	What is evaluated	Format
SPS Presentation	Problem understanding, structured analysis, As-Is/To-Be, hypothesis quality	Slides or document
Check-in Point 1	Solution direction, module map, role lenses, lo-fi wireframes, design rationale	Slides or document
Check-in Point 2	Fully built and functional virtual lab + build spec document	Working HTML demo + spec document

3. Structured Problem Solving — Your Discovery Process

3.1 What is SPS?

Structured Problem Solving (SPS) is a consulting methodology that helps you move from an ambiguous problem statement to a clear, evidence-backed solution. It is the same approach used in top consulting firms and is a core skill at Acies Global.

Good SPS means:

- You understand the problem before jumping to a solution
- Your thinking is MECE — Mutually Exclusive, Collectively Exhaustive
- You test hypotheses rather than assert opinions
- You use evidence to validate or invalidate assumptions
- Your recommendations are specific and actionable

3.2 SPS Steps for This Program

Follow these steps in sequence. Do not begin building until you have completed Steps 1–4.

Step 1: Frame the Problem

Start with your lab's problem brief. Write a clear problem statement in this structure:

"[Target user] struggles to [do what] because [root cause], which results in [business impact]."

Then define success criteria (3–5 measurable outcomes), scope (in/out), and initial assumptions.

Step 2: Build the Diagnostic Issue Tree

An issue tree is a MECE breakdown of your problem.

- **Diagnostic issue tree** — "Why does this problem exist?"
- **Solution issue tree** — "How could this problem be solved?"

Both are required. Issue trees must be 3+ levels deep, MECE at every level, with testable hypotheses at leaf nodes.

Step 3: Map the As-Is State

Map the current business process as a swimlane or linear flow. Label each step with the responsible role. Identify where things go wrong — delays, errors, blind spots, manual workarounds.

Step 4: Research and Validate

Use stakeholder interviews (see Section 4) and secondary research to test your hypotheses. Document each hypothesis as Validated / Partial / Invalidated with evidence.

Step 5: Define the To-Be State

Define the improved process or workflow, the KPIs that improve, the role of AI, and the role of the Agentic Bus. This becomes your lab's solution concept.

Step 6: Design the Lab Solution

Translate the To-Be state into 5 lab modules. Each module should answer a specific question for a specific role. This becomes your module/tab map.

4. Stakeholder Interview Guidance

4.1 Who to Interview

Each team should interview at least 3–5 people across:

- An LST member with experience in the relevant functional domain
- Account managers with the problem area
- An Acies Global consultant with relevant experience (analyst, planner, manager)
- An industry contact (optional)

Use the **Stakeholder Interview Template** as a guide to good interviews.

4.2 Core Question Categories

- **Problem framing:** What is the biggest challenge? What decisions are hardest?
- **Current state:** How does the key process work today? What systems are used?
- **Pain points:** What would you change first? What workarounds exist?

- **Decision making:** Who decides what? How far in advance are problems visible?
- **Success criteria:** What would 10x improvement look like? What KPIs matter?
- **Data and technology:** What data exists but isn't used well? What has been tried?

4.3 Interview Best Practices

- Prepare a 1-page guide before each session
- Summarize notes within 24 hours
- Ask "why" and "what does that mean in practice?" — surface-level answers are not enough
- Capture surprises — things that contradict your initial assumptions are the most valuable findings
- Document quotes; they are powerful in the SPS presentation

5. Lab Architecture and Common Shell

Every lab must follow the **Acies Agentic Bus Shell** so all 8 labs feel like one coherent product family.

5.1 Shell Layout

```
+-----+
| HEADER: Acies Global AgenticBus | [Lab Name] | [Role Selector] | [Tour] |
+-----+
|                                     |
| MAIN CANVAS: Interactive Module Tabs (hero of the experience) |
| +---+---+---+---+---+-----+    |
| |Tab1|Tab2|Tab3|Tab4|Tab5| How This Evolves >    |    |
| +---+---+---+---+---+-----+    |
| |                                     |    |
| | [Interactive module content for active tab]    |    |
| | Charts, filters, drilldowns, simulators, panels |    |
| |                                     |    |
| +-----+-----+    |
|                                     |
| "How This Evolves" SIDE PANEL — slides in from right    |
| Now --> AI-Assisted --> Acies Global AgenticBus + agent roster    |
|                                     |
+-----+
```

5.2 Required Shell Elements

Element	Description
Header	"Acies Global AgenticBus" + lab name + role selector + tour button + mode toggle
5 interactive module tabs	Domain tabs; each a functional view the user can explore
"How This Evolves" panel trigger	Button or tab that opens the side panel
Role selector	2–3 functional role lenses; changes tour and tooltip content
Guided tour	6–7 steps, role-aware, skippable, restartable
Tooltips	On key UI elements; 6-field standard template
"How This Evolves" side panel	Slides in from right; contains Now / AI / AgenticBus / agents / POV
Self-assessment scorecard	6–8 questions; outputs a maturity band
Consulting CTA	Buttons to invite other actions
Light + dark mode	Toggle in header
Mobile responsive	Works at 375px

5.3 "How This Evolves" Side Panel — 5 Required Sections

1. **Now** — how this function operates today and why it falls short
2. **AI-Assisted** — what changes when AI and analytics are applied
3. **Acies Global AgenticBus** — the agentic future state with orchestrated workflows
4. **Agent Roster** — 4–6 named agents (name, role, one-line description)
5. **Acies Global POV** — 2–3 sentences of thought leadership on where this domain is heading

5.4 Tooltip Standard Template (6 Fields)

Field	Content
Feature name	What is this element called?
Current gap	Does this look broken or incomplete today?
AI opportunity	What does AI improve here?
Agentic evolution	How would the Agentic Bus handle this in the future state?
Business impact	What KPI improves? By how much? (use research-backed estimates)
Data dependency	What data is needed to make this work?

Tooltips must be **role-aware**: different framing for VP vs practitioner on the same element.

5.5 Guided Tour (6–7 Steps)

Step	Content
1	Welcome + role selector
2	Problem snapshot — the "before" picture
3	Module walkthrough A — key tab
4	Module walkthrough B — second key tab or simulation
5	"How This Evolves" — point to side panel; Agentic Bus story
6	Consulting CTA

5.6 Consulting CTA

Buttons: "Book a diagnostic workshop" · "Browse Use Cases" · "Explore another lab"

6. Design System Rules

All labs must use the Acies Global design language.

Remember these non-negotiables:

- Acies Global colors
Yellow (#ffd966)
Gray (#252525)
 - DM Serif Display (Headings)
Roboto (Body)
 - Solid accent buttons, — or a light yellow gradient at max
 - No gradient backgrounds. White or Off White backgrounds preferred.
 - No colored side-borders on cards. Alpha-blended borders only
 - Left-aligned body text by default
 - Both light and dark mode, both working well
 - Tested at 375px mobile and 1280px desktop
-

7. Required Artifacts Checklist

Step 1 — SPS Presentation

- ☐ Problem statement (user / struggle / root cause / impact)
- ☐ Success criteria (3–5 measurable outcomes)
- ☐ Scope table (in scope / out of scope)
- ☐ Stakeholder map + interview summary log
- ☐ Secondary research summary with citations
- ☐ Diagnostic issue tree (MECE, 3+ levels)
- ☐ Solution issue tree (MECE, 3+ levels)
- ☐ As-Is process flow (swimlane or linear, roles labelled)
- ☐ Pain-point heatmap or prioritized pain matrix
- ☐ Hypothesis list with validation status + evidence
- ☐ To-Be operating concept (narrative + process flow)
- ☐ KPI tree

- ☐ Assumptions, risks, and open questions log

Check-in Point 1 — Solution Concept

- ☐ Finalized To-Be flow
- ☐ Role lens matrix
- ☐ Module/tab map with rationale
- ☐ Information architecture diagram
- ☐ "How This Evolves" content outline (all 5 sections)
- ☐ Draft tooltip framework (5+ tooltips, all 6 fields)
- ☐ Guided tour storyboard (role variants at steps 3–5)
- ☐ CTA use cases
- ☐ Lo-fi wireframes (all 5 tabs + side panel + scorecard)
- ☐ Design rationale
- ☐ Risks and dependencies

Check-in Point 2 — Built Lab + Build Spec

- ☐ Fully functional virtual lab (HTML/CSS/JS)
- ☐ All 5 interactive tabs built
- ☐ Role selector working
- ☐ Guided tour (6–7 steps; skip and restart)
- ☐ Minimum 10 tooltips (all 6 fields, role-aware)
- ☐ "How This Evolves" side panel working
- ☐ Light + dark mode
- ☐ Mobile responsive at 375px
- ☐ Final build specification (using the template)
- ☐ Architecture diagram
- ☐ Entity / data model
- ☐ Acceptance criteria per module
- ☐ 15-minute demo script

10. Key Frameworks Reference

MECE: Mutually Exclusive, Collectively Exhaustive. Every branch covers a distinct portion of the problem; together they cover all of it.

As-Is / To-Be: Paired process flows. As-Is shows the current state with pain points. To-Be shows the future state with the solution.

Hypothesis-Driven Problem Solving: Form a hypothesis early, seek evidence to validate or invalidate it, update as you learn.

KPI Tree: Hierarchical map from top-line outcomes → process metrics → module-level indicators. Ensures modules connect to real business value.

End of Master Program Guidance Document

Build Spec Template

Build Specification Template

Use this template for your Check-in 2 deliverable

Version: 1.0 | April 2026

Document Header

Field	Value
Lab name	[e.g., Revenue Growth Studio]
Team	[Team name / members]
Domain	[e.g., Marketing / Growth]
Target VP persona	[e.g., VP Marketing, VP Growth]
Secondary personas	[e.g., Campaign Manager, Marketing Ops]
Submission date	

Section 1: Lab Summary

1.1 Problem Statement (Finalized)

[Paste your finalized problem statement: User / struggle / root cause / impact]

1.2 Success Criteria

1.3 Scope

In Scope	Out of Scope

1.4 Key Assumptions

Section 2: User Roles and Role Lenses

2.1 Role Lens Matrix

Role Lens	Who they are	Primary concerns	Default tab	KPI emphasis	Tour/tooltip emphasis
Role 1					
Role 2					
Role 3					

2.2 How Role Selection Changes the Experience

Role 1: [2–3 sentences]

Role 2: [2–3 sentences]

Role 3: [2–3 sentences]

Section 3: Module / Tab Specifications

Tab 1: [Name]

Field	Detail
Primary question answered	
Primary role(s)	
KPIs displayed	
Key interactions	
Sample data required	
VP-level framing	
Practitioner framing	

Tooltips for this tab:

Tooltip target	Current gap	AI opportunity	Agentic evolution	Business impact	Data dependency

Tab 2: [Name]

(Repeat Tab 1 structure)

Tab 3: [Name]

(Repeat Tab 1 structure)

Tab 4: [Name]

(Repeat Tab 1 structure)

Tab 5: [Name]

(Repeat Tab 1 structure)

Section 4: "How This Evolves" Side Panel

Now — Current State

[2–3 sentences on how this function operates today and why it falls short]

AI-Assisted

[2–3 sentences on what AI and analytics change]

Acies Agentic Bus — Orchestrated Future

[2–3 sentences on agentic future state]

Agent Roster

Agent Name	Role	One-line description

Acies POV

[2–3 sentences of thought leadership on where this domain is heading]

Section 5: Guided Tour Script

Step	Tour step	VP script	Practitioner script
1	Welcome + role selector		
2	Problem snapshot		
3	Module A walkthrough		
4	Module B walkthrough		
5	"How This Evolves" beat		
6	Consulting CTA		

Section 7: Architecture

7.1 Architecture Layers

Layer	What it contains
Presentation	HTML/CSS/JS; tabs, tour, tooltips, side panel, scorecard
Data / State	In-memory sample data (JSON); role state; tour state

Interaction logic	Tab switching, tooltip rendering, tour, scorecard scoring
Design system	CSS variables (tokens), typography, color modes, spacing

7.2 Entity / Data Model

Entity	Key fields	Used in tab(s)

7.3 Interaction / Event Map

User action	What happens
Selects a role	Tour path and tooltip emphasis update
Clicks a tab	Active tab content renders
Opens side panel	Panel slides in from right
Hovers tooltip target	Tooltip renders with role-appropriate content
Clicks tour button	Tour starts at Step 1
Completes scorecard	Score calculated; result + CTA renders

Section 8: Design System Compliance Checklist

Requirement	Status
CSS custom property tokens	☐
Fluid type scale using clamp()	☐
4px spacing system	☐
Nexus warm beige + teal accent palette	☐
Cabinet Grotesk display + Satoshi body fonts loaded	☐
Light mode	☐

Dark mode	[]
Dark/light toggle in header	[]
No gradient buttons	[]
No colored side-borders on cards	[]
Alpha-blended borders only	[]
No icon-in-circle decoration	[]
Left-aligned body text	[]
Mobile responsive at 375px	[]
All images have alt text	[]
Touch targets minimum 44x44px	[]
Keyboard navigable	[]
No localStorage / sessionStorage	[]

Section 9: Acceptance Criteria

Module	Criterion	Pass/Fail
Role selector	Updates tour and tooltip content on selection	
Tabs	All 5 tabs render correctly; no broken states	
Side panel	Slides in from right; all 5 sections present; closes cleanly	
Guided tour	6–7 steps; skip and restart work	
Tooltips	Minimum 10 present; all 6 fields shown	
Scorecard	Scoring calculates correct band; result shown	

CTA	All 4 stages visible; buttons functional	
Dark mode	All elements legible; no broken contrast	
Mobile	No overflow at 375px; touch targets accessible	
Performance	Page loads under 3 seconds	

Section 10: Build Plan and Risks

Recommended Build Sequence

1. Design tokens and base stylesheet
2. Common shell (header, tab frame, footer)
3. "How This Evolves" side panel
4. Tab 1 (most important module)
5. Tabs 2–5
6. Guided tour overlay
7. Tooltips
8. Scorecard + scoring logic
9. Consulting CTA screen
10. Role selector logic integrated
11. Dark mode and mobile pass
12. QA and demo script

Risks

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Sample data not realistic	Medium	High	Research real KPI benchmarks

Scope creep	High	Medium	Strictly 5 tabs; defer everything else
Design inconsistency	Medium	High	Build from tokens first; review every tab
Mobile layout breaks	Medium	High	Test at 375px after each build step

Section 11: 15-Minute Demo Script

Time	What you show	What you say
0–1 min	Lab landing	Introduce the lab and experience
1–3 min	Role selector + problem snapshot	Establish the "before" picture
3–6 min	Tab 1 and Tab 2	Walk the two most impactful modules
6–8 min	Tab 3 or a simulation moment	Show something interactive
8–10 min	"How This Evolves" panel	Walk Now / AI / AgenticBus
10–12 min	Scorecard	Invite self-assessment; show maturity output
12–15 min	Consulting CTA	Introduce the engagement path; close

End of Build Specification Template

Interview Template

Stakeholder Interview Template

Program: Acies Virtual Labs Capstone Program

Interview Details

Field	Value
Lab	
Interviewee name	
Role / Title	
Organisation / Function	
Interviewer(s)	
Date	
Duration	
Interview format	In-person / Video / Phone

Pre-Interview Preparation

Before the interview:

- ☐ Reviewed the lab problem brief
- ☐ Identified 3 hypotheses you want to test in this interview
- ☐ Prepared this guide and shared it with team members joining

3 hypotheses to test:

- 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

Opening (2 minutes)

Introduce the program and what you are building. Explain that this is a discovery conversation — there are no right or wrong answers. You want to understand their real experience.

Section 1: Role and Context (5 minutes)

1. Can you describe your role and the team you lead?
2. What are the 2–3 most important outcomes your function is measured on?
3. What does a typical week look like for you?

Notes:

Section 2: Current State and Pain Points (15 minutes)

4. What is the single biggest operational challenge in [domain area] right now?
5. Walk me through how [key process] works today, step by step.
6. What tools and systems are used? How well do they talk to each other?
7. Where does data quality or availability break down?
8. What decisions do you wish you could make faster or more accurately?
9. What keeps you up at night about this function?
10. What workarounds has your team built because the official process doesn't work?

Notes:

Section 3: Decisions and Information (10 minutes)

11. Who makes the key decisions in this area? On what basis? How often?
12. What information do you wish you had before making [key decision]?
13. How far in advance do problems usually become visible?
14. What does a typical bad week look like versus a good week?

Notes:

Section 4: Technology and Data (5 minutes)

15. What data exists but isn't being used well?
16. What would need to be connected for this to work better?
17. What has been tried before? Why didn't it work?

Notes:

Section 5: Success and Future (5 minutes)

18. If a technology solution solved this well, what would you see change in 6 months?
19. What KPIs would you track to know it's working?
20. What would a 10x improvement in this function look like?

Notes:

Closing (2 minutes)

- Is there anything important we haven't covered?
 - Is there anyone else we should speak to?
 - Can we follow up with any clarifying questions?
-

Post-Interview Summary (complete within 24 hours)

Field	Content
Most important insight	
Biggest surprise (something that contradicted an assumption)	
Hypothesis 1 result	Validated / Partial / Invalidated — evidence:
Hypothesis 2 result	Validated / Partial / Invalidated — evidence:

Hypothesis 3 result	Validated / Partial / Invalidated — evidence:
Key quote(s)	
Follow-up questions	
Implications for lab design	

End of Stakeholder Interview Template